

IN PRINCIPIO

WEDDINGS BY KIM & IVAN

a quick start companion to your

Pose Reference Pack

SONY EDITION

For Sony A7 III, A7 IV, and A7 V · inprincipioweddings.com

i.

Welcome

Thank you for choosing this pack. What follows is everything you need to move it from a file on your computer to a working part of your camera; it should take about three minutes the first time you do it.

The pack you've downloaded is a small set of JPEG image files prepared specifically for Sony bodies. Each image carries a posing reference, a short prompt to use with the couple, and a framing note. The files were built and tested on real cameras (A7 III, A7 IV, and A7 V) so that, once they are on an SD card, your camera treats them as ordinary photos and lets you scroll through them on the back screen the same way you would your own work.

No app. No phone. No signal. Just the camera you're already holding.

A note before you begin

Sony's playback engine is particular about what it accepts; files prepared for one camera brand are not portable to another. This pack is for Sony Alpha bodies only. If you mainly shoot Canon, Nikon, Fujifilm, or anything else, write to us before you set up so we can confirm whether a build for your body exists yet.

The instructions on the following pages assume the same conditions we tested under: a clean SD card, formatted in the camera, plus a moment with the card in your computer to copy files across. Nothing exotic.

ii.

Set up the SD card

The pack needs to live in the folder Sony cameras expect to find photos in. This is a one-time setup; afterwards, you only touch the card again to swap references in or out.

Format the card

- 1 Insert the SD card into your camera (slot 1 if you shoot dual-card).
- 2 Open MENU → Setup → Media → Format and confirm.
- 3 Take one ordinary photo; a wall, a coffee cup, anything. This is what makes the camera create the DCIM/100MSDCF/ folder the pack needs.
- 4 Power the camera down and take the SD card out.

If the folder already exists. *If you're working with an SD card that has been used in a Sony before, the DCIM/100MSDCF/ folder is probably already there. You can skip the format and the test photo entirely; just back up whatever you'd like to keep, since the next step adds files to that folder.*

ii. continued

Copy the files across

Once the card has a folder Sony recognises, the rest is a straight file-copy step. A card reader does this more reliably than connecting the camera over USB.

- 1 Connect the SD card to your computer with a card reader. Avoid plugging the camera itself in over USB; some bodies lock the file system in ways that can confuse what comes next.
- 2 Unzip the pack you downloaded. Inside you'll find a `DCIM/100MSDCF/` folder containing the JPEG files.
- 3 Open the SD card's `DCIM/100MSDCF/` folder and drop every `DSC0xxxx.JPG` from the pack into it.
- 4 If the computer asks whether to replace a file, choose Replace; this happens only if your test photo and one of the pack files share a filename, and the replacement is a clean overwrite.
- 5 Eject the SD card cleanly. On Mac: click the eject arrow next to the card in Finder, or press `⌘E`. On Windows: use Safely Remove Hardware.

Important. *Copy only the JPEG files; not the ZIP itself, not this PDF, not any other folders. The camera can be confused by anything other than image files inside DCIM.*

iii.

On shoot day

The pack lives on the SD card as ordinary photos. There is no app to open, no menu to navigate to; everything works through the same playback controls you already use.

- 1 Insert the SD card and power the camera on.
- 2 Press the Playback button (▶). The pack appears in the gallery alongside any shoot photos already on the card.
- 3 Scroll through with the joystick or the rear wheel.
- 4 Press **DISP** on any reference to reveal the prompt text and framing notes.
- 5 To leave playback and go back to shooting, half-press the shutter.

In practice. *Some photographers leave the camera in playback between frames and only exit when ready to release the shutter. The reference stays on screen until the shutter is pressed, so it can stay open while you direct the couple.*

If the pack doesn't appear

Most Sony bodies pick the files up the moment the card goes in. Some want a small nudge: MENU → Setup → Media → Recover Image Database and confirm Yes. The rebuild takes ten to thirty seconds; afterwards the pack is there.

Carrying only what you need

The pack works best when the card holds only the references that fit the day in front of you. For a wedding you may pull thirty or forty across getting-ready, ceremony, and portraits; for a portrait session, less. Keep the master pack unzipped on your computer and treat the SD card as a working space you re-arrange between sessions.

iv.

Care, troubles, and how to reach us

Most issues come down to one of two things: the files weren't copied into the right folder, or the camera hasn't been told to look. Both take less than a minute to resolve.

If something looks wrong on the camera

If the references don't show at all, or appear as corrupted images, walk back through this short list:

- The files copied across are only .JPG; no ZIP, no folders, no other formats.
- They are inside DCIM/100MSDCF/, and not loose in DCIM or in any other folder.
- You ran Recover Image Database from MENU → Setup → Media after inserting the card.
- The card was ejected cleanly from the computer before going back into the camera; sudden disconnects can leave the file system half-written.

If the issue stays after all four checks, format the card in the camera again (after backing up anything you want to keep), take a fresh test photo, and re-copy the pack. A fresh format resolves the great majority of edge cases.

If you'd like to write to us

We read every message ourselves; the pack is small enough that personal replies are still the norm. The most useful thing you can include is your camera body and firmware version (MENU → Setup → Setup Option → Version) plus a short description of what's happening. If you can, attach a photo of the camera screen taken with your phone.

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